

Generated from the competition table

1981 Men's Ballon d'Or

Everything the Men's Ballon d'Or table records about 1981, with the winner linked to their full award history and their national team linked to its own record.

Winner

Karl-Heinz Rummenigge

National team

West Germany

Ceremony date

29 December 1981

All Men's Ballon d'Or editions →



References & review

Status: verified

Last reviewed: 3 September 2026

- Official winners and rankings (<https://ballondor.com/all-rankings>)
- Official homepage (<https://ballondor.com/>).
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (source 1 of 5) (<https://www.rsssf.org/miscellaneous/europa-poy65.html>).
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (source 2 of 5) (<https://www.britannica.com/topic/Ballon-dOr>).
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (source 3 of 5) (<https://www.jeuneafrique.com/381505/politique/jour-26-decembre-1995-george-weah-elu-ballon-dor/>).
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (source 4 of 5) (<https://www.voanews.com/>).
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (source 5 of 5) (<https://www.uefa.com/uefachampionsleague/news/>).

- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (source 1 of 9) (https://www.si.com/soccer/what-is-the-kopa-trophy-past-winners-nominees-2025)
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (source 2 of 9) (https://www.90min.com/what-is-kopa-trophy-past-winners-nominees)
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (source 3 of 9) (https://www.topendsports.com/sport/soccer/awards/kopa-trophy.htm)
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (source 4 of 9) (https://www.sportsdunia.com/football-analysis/list-of-kopa-trophy-winners)
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (source 5 of 9) (https://www.chaseyoursport.com/football/list-of-kopa-trophy-winners/8061)
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (source 6 of 9) (https://www.givemesport.com/every-winner-kopa-trophy-ranked/)
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (source 7 of 9) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Kopa_Trophy).
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (source 8 of 9) (https://www.fcbarcelona.com/en/football/first-team/news/4367534/lamine-yamal-retains-kopa-trophy/featured).
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (source 9 of 9) (https://www.tntsports.co.uk/football/ballon-d-or/2025/lamine-yamal-retains-kopa-trophy-for-best-young-player-vicky-lopez-takes-inaugural-womens-prize sto23224406/story.shtml).
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 1 of 11) (https://www.topendsports.com/sport/soccer/awards/yashin-trophy.htm).
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 2 of 11) (https://www.premierleague.com/en/news/4420829/donnarumma-and-gyokeres-win-awards-at-2025-ballon-dor).
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 3 of 11) (https://goaltheball.com/yashin-trophy-winners-list/)
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 4 of 11) (https://www.fotmob.com/el/news/x3syvn394xhu179pkuk2k9k4y/ballon-d'or-2019-liverpool-goalkeeper-alisson-wins-inaugural-yachine-trophy)
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 5 of 11) (https://www.goal.com/en-ca/lists/aston-villa-and-argentina-goalkeeper-emiliano-martinez-retains-yashin-trophy-as-world-s-best-goalkeeper-in-2024/blt47f77564722f26b5)

- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 6 of 11) (https://fr.wikipedia.org/wiki/Troph%C3%A9e_Yachine).
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 7 of 11) (https://www.footmercato.net/a7278391082899020163-ballon-dor-2025-gianluigi-donnarumma-remporte-le-trophee-yachine).
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 8 of 11) (https://www.realmadrid.com/en-US/news/football/first-team/special-features/courtois-yashin-trophy-winner-2022).
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 9 of 11) (https://www.tntsports.co.uk/football/ballon-d-or/2022/ballon-dor-2022-thibaut-courtois-wins-yashin-trophy-for-best-goalkeeper-after-real-madrid-heroics-la_sto9191911/story.shtml).
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 10 of 11) (https://www.90min.com/posts/emiliano-martinez-wins-2023-yashin-trophy).
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 11 of 11) (https://www.besoccer.com/new/emiliano-martinez-wins-back-to-back-yachine-trophy-awards-1335839).
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (source 1 of 10) (https://www.topendsports.com/sport/soccer/awards/striker-of-the-year.htm)
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (source 2 of 10) (https://www.90min.com/what-is-gerd-muller-trophy-past-winners-nominees)
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (source 3 of 10) (https://www.gamereactor.eu/what-is-the-gerd-muller-trophy-and-who-will-win-this-year-at-ballon-dor-2025-1605433/)
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (source 4 of 10) (https://www.arsenal.com/news/viktor-gyokeres-wins-gerd-muller-trophy)
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (source 5 of 10) (https://fcbayern.com/en/news/2022/10/muller-trophy-for-year%E2%80%99s-best-striker-awarded-for-the-first-time-at-the-ballon-dor-ceremony)
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (source 6 of 10) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Gerd_M%C3%BCller_Trophy)
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (source 7 of 10) (https://www.bavarianfootballworks.com/2022/10/18/23409746/robert-lewandowski-striker-award-2022-gerd-muller-fc-barcelona-bayern-munich-alum-haaland-benzema)

- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (source 8 of 10) (<https://www.fcbarcelona.com/en/news/2858120/lewandowski-wins-inaugural-gerd-muller-trophy/featured>)
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (source 9 of 10) (<https://www.fourfourtwo.com/features/ballon-dor-what-is-the-gerd-muller-trophy>).
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (source 10 of 10) (<https://sports.yahoo.com/article/won-gerd-muller-trophy-2025-201726350.html>).
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (source 1 of 9) ([https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Johan_Cruyff_Trophy_\(France_Football\)\)](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Johan_Cruyff_Trophy_(France_Football)))).
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (source 2 of 9) (<https://www.goal.com/en-us/lists/carlo-ancelotti-men-s-coach-of-year-ballon-d-or-ceremony-xabi-alonso-pep-guardiola/blt4f9630905d966f8d>).
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (source 3 of 9) (<https://www.besoccer.com/new/real-madrid-boss-ancelotti-wins-men-s-johan-cruyff-trophy-1335838>).
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (source 4 of 9) (<https://www.beinsports.com/en-us/soccer/articles-video/ancelotti-is-the-best-coach-of-the-year-2024-10-28>).
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (source 5 of 9) (<https://www.managingmadrid.com/2024/10/28/24282158/carlo-ancelotti-wins-coach-of-the-year-award>).
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (source 6 of 9) (<https://sports.yahoo.com/article/psg-head-coach-luis-enrique-193800045.html>).
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (source 7 of 9) (<https://www.besoccer.com/new/luis-enrique-wins-2025-johan-cruyff-trophy-for-world-s-best-coach-1374497>).
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (source 8 of 9) (<https://www.caughtoffside.com/2025/09/22/ballon-dor-2025-luis-enrique-best-coach/>).
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (source 9 of 9) (<https://tribuna.com/en/news/2025-09-22-luis-enrique-wins-johan-cruyff-trophy-at-2025-ballon-dor/>).
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 1 of 11) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/S%C3%B3crates_Award).

- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 2 of 11) (<https://www.peace-sport.org/socrates-award/>)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 3 of 11) (<https://www.peace-sport.org/news/the-senegalese-sadio-mane-becomes-the-first-winner-of-the-socrates-award-at-the-2022-ballon-dor-ceremony/>)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 4 of 11) (<https://fcbayern.com/en/news/2022/10/sadio-mane-the-inaugural-winner-of-the-socrates-award>)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 5 of 11) (<https://www.peace-sport.org/news/vinicius-junior-wins-socrates-award-at-the-2023-ballon-dor-ceremony/>)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 6 of 11) (<https://www.besoccer.com/new/vinicius-wins-socrates-2023-award-for-his-humanitarian-work-1287586>)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 7 of 11) (<https://www.90min.com/what-is-socrates-award-past-winners-nominees>)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 8 of 11) (<https://www.olympics.com/en/news/football-2025-all-winners-all-awards-complete-list-live-updates>)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 9 of 11) (<https://www.peace-sport.org/news/h-s-h-prince-albert-ii-and-peace-and-sport-welcome-the-xana-foundation-winner-of-the-2025-socrates-award-in-monaco-2/>)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 10 of 11) (<https://www.monaco-tribune.com/en/2025/09/09/football-dor-2025-ceremony-princess-charlene-presents-socrates-prize-to-xana-foundation/>)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 11 of 11) (<https://www.gamereactor.eu/luis-enriques-xana-foundation-named-after-his-late-daughter-wins-socrates-award-for-humanitarian-work-1605953/>)

Primary sources are preferred. Historical formats and team names are recorded as used at the time; see each edition's notes for context.